

## Microsoft acquires Nokia's devices and services unit for \$7.2 billion



The rumours that were doing the rounds for a long time now have finally been proved right with Microsoft buying Nokia's devices and services unit. A Microsoft post read, "Under the terms of the agreement, Microsoft will pay EUR (convert to \$) 3.79 billion to purchase substantially all of Nokia's devices and services business, and EUR 1.65 billion to license Nokia's patents, for a total transaction price of EUR 5.44 billion in cash. Microsoft will draw upon its overseas cash resources to fund the transaction. The transaction is expected to close in the first quarter of 2014, subject to approval by Nokia's shareholders, regulatory approvals and other closing conditions."

The amount involved is comparatively low compared to the deal Microsoft struck with Skype in 2011. As a result of the deal, over 32,000 employees of Nokia are expected to be transferred to the world's leading consumer software company. This employee force includes 4,700 people in Finland and 18,300 employees directly from manufacturing units across the world.

Steve Ballmer, CEO, Microsoft, described this as a bold step and a win-win situation for employees, shareholders and consumers of both companies. Risto Siilasmaa, chairman of the Nokia board of directors, said, "For Nokia, this is an important moment of reinvention and from a position of financial strength, we can build our next chapter."

Linux kernel 3.11 include LZ4 compression, Zswap, XFS and EXT4 file system improvements, inclusion of Lustre, Dynamic Power Management (DPM) for Radeon GPUs, new DRM display, AVX2 optimisation, ARM improvements, Power PC architecture updates, input device and audio stack improvements, among others.

## Canonical releases Ubuntu 12.04.3 LTS

The Ubuntu team recently announced the release of Ubuntu 12.04.3 LTS (Long-Term Support) for its desktop, server, cloud and core products, together with other flavours of Ubuntu with long-term support.

Ubuntu 12.04.3 LTS includes various updates that were released post-12.04 (and 12.04.2, for that matter) including an updated kernel and X stack for new installations on x86 architectures.

The release includes many other updates; updated installation media has been provided so that the user needs fewer updates after the installation. These include security updates and corrections for other high-impact bugs, with a focus on maintaining stability and compatibility with Ubuntu 12.04 LTS.

Kubuntu 12.04.3 LTS, Edubuntu 12.04.3 LTS, Xubuntu 12.04.3 LTS, Mythbuntu 12.04.3 LTS and Ubuntu Studio 12.04.3 LTS are also now available. You can find more details on the announcements at:

Kubuntu: <http://www.kubuntu.org/news/12.04.3-release>

Edubuntu: <http://www.edubuntu.org/news/12.04.3-release>

Mythbuntu: <http://www.mythbuntu.org/home/news/12043released>

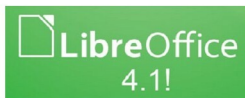
Ubuntu Studio: <https://help.ubuntu.com/community/PreciseUpgrades>



## Updated LibreOffice 4.1.1 released

LibreOffice is clearly one of the most sought after Linux office suites. The latest news is that LibreOffice has got another update, in addition to the 4.1 version rolled out last month. LibreOffice 4.1.1 reportedly comes with '...a large number of improved interoperability features with proprietary and legacy file formats.' The version has been developed keeping the interests of those wanting features for enterprise adoptions.

This version comes with a number of bug fixes. One of the bugs fixed in this release is the fdo#67388, in which files in .deb packages were not owned by root:root. Another bug fixed is fdo#67235 wherein the Timefield was limited automatically to a maximum of 00:00:01 in Base. Additionally, Calc patched the issue related to 'Copying an email address and pasting it in a plain text editor shows U+0001 instead of the email address.'



## Indian companies shifting to open source software

Increased licensing costs due to the falling rupee are pushing Indian firms to switch to open source software. According to a report, companies are recognising the cost benefits and flexibility offered by such software compared